

# RAPID CORTEX

## QR Code Installation Guide

Rapid Cortex Campus · Rapid Cortex Venue · Rapid Cortex 911  
*How to generate, size, print, and place QR codes on safety reporting signs*

5 minutes per location

Works on any smartphone

No app download required

### Overview

A QR (Quick Response) code is a printed square pattern that smartphones can read with their camera. When someone points their camera at it, their phone automatically opens a web page. No app, no login, and no typing required.

For Rapid Cortex, each QR code is linked to a specific agency and location. Scanning it opens the safety reporting form for that exact place. The report is received instantly by your security or dispatch team.

**NOTE** QR codes and NFC tags on the same sign point to the same URL. QR codes work on older phones and require a camera. NFC tags work on newer phones and require only a tap. Together they cover every phone.

### What You Need

You have two options for printing QR codes: print in-house on a standard printer, or send the file to a sign vendor. Both produce working codes.

| Item                                            | Details                                                                                | Where to Get It                        |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Rapid Cortex admin access                       | Log in to generate and download the QR code PNG for each location                      | app.rapidcortex.us                     |
| Color or B&W laser printer (in-house printing)  | 600 DPI or higher. Inkjet works but laser is more durable. B&W prints scan fine.       | Your office                            |
| Glossy or matte label paper (in-house printing) | Letter size adhesive sheets. Use matte to reduce camera glare.                         | Amazon, Staples, Office Depot          |
| Sign design file (vendor printing)              | Include the downloaded QR PNG in your sign artwork at the correct size (see Section 3) | Your design file                       |
| Sign vendor (vendor printing)                   | Any print vendor that accepts PNG files. Provide at minimum 400×400px at 300 DPI.      | Vistaprint, Signazon, local print shop |

**WARNING** Always download the QR code from the Rapid Cortex dashboard — do not use a third-party QR code generator. Only Rapid Cortex-generated codes track scans and route reports to your console.

## 1

## Generate the QR Code

Log in to Rapid Cortex and download the PNG for this sign location

Every sign location gets its own unique QR code. Generating one takes about 60 seconds.

1

### Log in to the Rapid Cortex admin dashboard

Go to [app.rapidcortex.us](https://app.rapidcortex.us) and sign in with your admin account. RC platform admins, agency admins, campus admins, and venue admins can all generate QR codes.

2

### Navigate to QR & NFC Codes

From the sidebar, select your agency, then click “QR & NFC Codes.” RC platform admins go to RC Admin → Agencies → [Agency] → QR & NFC Codes.

3

### Click “+ New Code”

A form will appear. Fill in: Name (e.g., “McKinley Hall — 3rd Floor”), Zone/Location (e.g., “Building C, Floor 3”), Report Type (Anonymous, Identified, or Both), and Vertical (Campus, Venue, 911, etc.). Click Save.

4

### Click “Download PNG”

The QR code image will download as a PNG file to your computer. The filename will include the location name. Keep this file — you will use it for printing.

5

### Repeat for each sign location

Create one QR code per physical sign. Do not reuse the same QR code across multiple locations — you will not be able to tell which location a report came from.

**TIP** If you need to update the location name or zone later, you can edit it in the dashboard without reprinting the sign. The QR code URL stays the same — only the display information changes.

## 2

## Size the QR Code Correctly

Too small and it will not scan. Minimum 1.5 inches for reliable results.

The scanning distance determines the minimum size. A QR code that looks fine to the eye can fail to scan if it is too small or printed at low resolution.

| Viewing Distance    | Minimum QR Code Size                                                      |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Up to 1 foot (30cm) | 1.5 inches (3.8cm) minimum — recommended for desk stands and door plaques |
| 1–3 feet (30–90cm)  | 2 inches (5cm) minimum — recommended for wall-mounted signs               |
| 3–6 feet (0.9–1.8m) | 3 inches (7.5cm) minimum — recommended for poster-size signs              |

| Viewing Distance | Minimum QR Code Size                                                     |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6+ feet (1.8m+)  | 5 inches (12.5cm) minimum — recommended for large lobby or stadium signs |

**TIP** When in doubt, go larger. A 3-inch QR code on a wall sign is never too big and always reliable. A 1-inch code on a wall sign will frustrate users and generate false “won’t scan” complaints.

### File resolution requirements

The downloaded PNG from Rapid Cortex is 400×400 pixels. This is sufficient for:

|                                  |                                                                           |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| In-house laser print at 2 inches | ✓ Sharp and scannable at 200 DPI effective                                |
| In-house laser print at 3 inches | ✓ Acceptable at 133 DPI effective — use the largest download available    |
| Professional print at 3 inches   | ✓ Request a high-resolution export from Rapid Cortex support if available |
| Large-format print over 6 inches | ⚠ Request SVG or high-DPI PNG from Rapid Cortex support for best results  |

**CAUTION** Never stretch a QR code. If you need it larger than the downloaded file supports cleanly, contact Rapid Cortex support for a higher resolution export. A distorted QR code will not scan.

## 3

**Print the QR Code**

In-house printing or vendor printing — requirements for both

**Option A — In-house printing**

Use this option for temporary signs, desk stands, or quick deployments. A standard office laser printer produces reliable codes.

1

**Open the downloaded PNG in your image viewer or word processor**

Do not open it in a browser — use Preview (Mac), Photos (Windows), or insert it into a Word document so you can control the print size precisely.

2

**Set the print size to your target dimensions**

In Preview: Tools → Adjust Size. In Word: right-click image → Size and Position. Set width and height to the same value (QR codes are always square).

3

**Print on matte paper or matte label stock**

Matte finish reduces glare. Glossy paper causes camera reflections that interfere with scanning. Print at the highest quality setting available.

4

**Do not laminate with high-gloss laminate**

Gloss laminate causes the same glare problem. If laminating, use matte (anti-glare) laminate only.

5

**Cut cleanly and leave the white border intact**

The white border around the QR code is called the quiet zone. It is required for scanning. Leave at least 4mm of white space on all sides when trimming.

**Option B — Sign vendor printing**

Use this option for permanent, professional-quality signs. Provide the following specifications to your sign vendor.

**Vendor Specification Sheet**

**File format:** PNG (provided). Request SVG from Rapid Cortex support for large-format prints over 6 inches.

**Colors:** Black on white only. Do not alter QR code colors. The finder patterns (three corner squares) must remain solid black.

**Quiet zone:** Maintain at least 4mm (0.16 inch) of white space on all four sides of the QR code. Do not crop into this border.

**Minimum size:** 1.5 inches (3.8cm) for close-range signs. 3 inches (7.5cm) recommended for wall signs. See Section 2 for size guide.

**Print quality:** Minimum 300 DPI at the final printed size. Laser or UV print preferred for outdoor signs.

**Distortion:** QR codes must be printed as a perfect square. Do not stretch, skew, or rotate the image.

**Surface finish:** Matte finish strongly preferred. If gloss finish is required, test scanning in bright light before full production run.

**Placement on sign:** QR code should appear in the lower half of the sign, below the instructional text, with call-to-action text above it.

## 4

## Sign Layout Best Practices

What to put on the sign above and below the QR code

A QR code on its own does not tell people what it does or why they should scan it. The sign needs a clear call to action above the code and brief instructions below it.

### Recommended sign copy per vertical

| Vertical    | Header text                       | Subtext                                                                    | Below QR                    |
|-------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| RC Campus   | See Something? Say Something.     | Scan to report directly to Campus Security.<br>Anonymous option available. | Scan with your phone camera |
| RC Venue    | Security Concern? Contact Us Now. | Scan to reach Venue Security directly. No app needed.                      | Scan with your phone camera |
| RC 911      | Report a Safety Concern           | Scan to submit a report directly to the communications center.             | Scan with your phone camera |
| RC Hospital | Report a Concern                  | Scan to reach hospital staff directly.                                     | Scan with your phone camera |
| RC Transit  | Safety Issue? Report It Now.      | Scan to contact Transit Security directly.                                 | Scan with your phone camera |

**TIP** Always include the text “Scan with your phone camera” below the QR code. Many users do not know that their camera app can read QR codes without downloading a separate scanner app.

### Accessibility

Include an SMS alternative on every sign for users who cannot scan QR codes. Example: “Or text SAFE to [your number].” This ensures the sign works for every user regardless of phone model or camera access.

## 5

**Test Before Deploying**

Test every code before the sign goes up

Test the printed code, not just the digital file. Printing can introduce artifacts that prevent scanning even when the digital image looked fine.

1

**Open your phone camera app — do not open a QR scanner app**

Modern iPhones (iOS 11+) and Android phones (Android 8+) read QR codes natively in the camera app. Point the camera at the printed code without pressing the shutter button.

2

**Hold the camera 12–18 inches from the printed code**

This is a typical reading distance for a wall sign. Keep the phone steady for 1–2 seconds. A yellow box or link banner should appear at the top of the screen.

3

**Tap the link that appears**

The Rapid Cortex reporting form should open in your browser within 2–3 seconds. No login prompt should appear.

4

**Confirm the correct form loads**

Check that the vertical label is correct (Campus Security, Venue Security, etc.) and the location name matches the sign location you created in the dashboard.

5

**Check the scan count in the dashboard**

Log in to the RC admin dashboard and confirm that the QR Scan Count for this code has increased by 1. If it has not, the form may have opened but the tracking call failed — check your internet connection at the sign location.

6

**Test from maximum expected reading distance**

If the sign will be mounted at eye level 3 feet from the nearest walkway, test from 3 feet. If it fails to scan, increase the QR code size before printing the final sign.

**CAUTION** If the camera does not detect the code: check that the quiet zone (white border) is intact, that the print has no smearing or blurring, and that the lighting at the test location is sufficient. Poor lighting is the most common scanning failure.

## 6

**Place and Mount the Sign**

Where and how to mount for maximum scan success

1

**Mount at eye level — between 4.5 and 5.5 feet from the floor**

Eye-level placement is the most natural scanning position. Avoid mounting above 6 feet or below 3 feet — users should not need to crouch or reach to scan.

2

**Ensure adequate lighting at the sign location**

Phone cameras need light to read QR codes. If the mounting location is dim, add a light source nearby. Entrance lighting, corridor lights, and desk lamps all work.

**3****Avoid direct glare sources**

Do not mount the sign facing a window or directly under a spotlight. Glare on the sign surface is the most common in-field scanning failure. Test scanning under the actual installed lighting before finalizing the mount position.

**4****Keep the sign flat and undamaged**

A buckled or torn QR code may not scan. Use a rigid backing material for paper codes. Protective laminate (matte only) extends the life of printed codes significantly.

**5****Place in high-visibility, high-traffic locations**

Signs should be placed where people are likely to need them: building entrances, elevator lobbies, stairwells, parking structures, restroom corridors, and event gathering areas.

**6****Do a final scan test after mounting**

Scan the installed sign from normal user distance under actual lighting conditions. Confirm the correct form loads and the scan count increments in the dashboard.

**WARNING** For outdoor signs, use UV-resistant laminate or a weatherproof sign material. Standard laser-printed paper will degrade within weeks in direct sunlight or rain.

## 7

**Troubleshooting**

Common issues and how to fix them

| Problem                                                 | Solution                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Camera does not detect the code                         | Check: adequate lighting, quiet zone not cropped, print is not blurry, phone camera is up to date. Try from closer range (6–12 inches). Ensure the printed code is flat and not behind heavy gloss laminate.                     |
| Code scans but wrong form opens                         | The wrong QR code PNG was printed for this location. Log in to the dashboard, find the correct code for this location, download the PNG again, and reprint.                                                                      |
| Code scans but “link inactive” page appears             | The QR code record was deactivated in the dashboard. Log in, find the code, and toggle it back to active. Or create a new code and reprint.                                                                                      |
| Scan count not updating                                 | The form loaded but the tracking call failed. Check the internet connection at the sign location. If connectivity is consistently poor, consider a different placement.                                                          |
| Some phones cannot scan it                              | iPhones below iPhone 6 and Android phones below Android 5 may not have native QR support. These users should use the SMS option on the sign. For environments with older-device populations, make the SMS number more prominent. |
| Code scans correctly but form shows wrong location name | Update the Zone Name in the Rapid Cortex dashboard for this QR code record. Changes take effect immediately — no reprint needed.                                                                                                 |
| Print is too dark or too light                          | QR codes require high contrast between the black modules and white background. If the print is faded, replace the toner/ink cartridge and reprint. If it is too dark with ink bleed, reduce print density in printer settings.   |
| Scan works on phone but not in testing app              | Always test with the native phone camera app. Third-party QR scanner apps may behave differently. The test that matters is the native camera experience.                                                                         |

## 8

**Quick Reference Card**

Print and keep with your sign installation supplies

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
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| <b>Pre-Installation Checklist</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li><input type="checkbox"/> QR code PNG downloaded from RC dashboard</li> <li><input type="checkbox"/> Correct location name in filename</li> <li><input type="checkbox"/> Printed at correct size (min 1.5 in)</li> <li><input type="checkbox"/> Quiet zone (white border) intact</li> <li><input type="checkbox"/> Matte finish — no heavy gloss</li> <li><input type="checkbox"/> Scans correctly from digital file</li> <li><input type="checkbox"/> Print tested and scans correctly</li> <li><input type="checkbox"/> Sign mounted at eye level</li> <li><input type="checkbox"/> Adequate lighting at location</li> <li><input type="checkbox"/> No direct glare on sign surface</li> </ul> | <b>Size Guide</b> <p><b>Desk / counter sign:</b> 1.5 in (3.8cm)</p> <p><b>Wall sign at arm reach:</b> 2 in (5cm)</p> <p><b>Corridor wall sign:</b> 3 in (7.5cm)</p> <p><b>Large lobby sign:</b> 5 in (12.5cm)</p> <b>Print Rules</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>✓ Black on white only</li> <li>✓ Minimum 300 DPI</li> <li>✓ Keep quiet zone intact</li> <li>✓ No stretching or rotation</li> <li>✓ Matte finish only</li> <li>✓ Test before mounting</li> </ul> |
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- ☐ Post-mount scan test passed
- ☐ Scan count confirmed in dashboard

- X No third-party QR generators
- X No gloss laminate
- X No cropping the border

### Need Help?

Contact Rapid Cortex Support

[support@rapidcortex.us](mailto:support@rapidcortex.us) · [rapidcortex.us](https://rapidcortex.us)